

Client acquisition playbook, retainer building system, proposal templates, client communication guides — Action Checklist

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SCORE YOUR CLIENT HISTORY

- ☐ **Score Your Client History:** Pull your last 8-10 client relationships and gather their project files, invoices, and correspondence to begin your analysis.
- ☐ **Score Your Client History:** Score each client across 5 profitability factors including effective hourly rate, communication overhead, scope creep history, payment reliability, and whether you'd work with them again.
- ☐ **Score Your Client History:** Identify your top 3 most profitable clients by looking for those who had high effective rates, low revision cycles, no scope creep, and paid on time.
- ☐ **Score Your Client History:** Document the 2-3 shared characteristics of your best clients such as industry, company size, budget range, how they found you, or their decision-making process.

BUILD YOUR AVATAR DOCUMENT

- ☐ **Build Your Avatar Document:** Write out answers to 7 specific questions about your ideal client including their industry, company size, decision-making process, budget range, and how they find vendors.
- ☐ **Build Your Avatar Document:** Describe the specific problem your ideal client is trying to solve right now and what a bad vendor experience has looked like for them in the past.
- ☐ **Build Your Avatar Document:** Identify where your ideal clients typically look for vendors like you and what their budget range is for projects similar to yours.
- ☐ **Build Your Avatar Document:** Treat your Client Avatar Document as a living reference point and pull it out every time you're considering a new client opportunity to quickly assess fit.

KNOW YOUR PRICING MESSAGE

- ☐ **Know Your Pricing Message:** Understand that your pricing sends a market signal about your availability, desperation level, and negotiating room that attracts matching clients.
 - ☐ **Know Your Pricing Message:** Recognize that a low price doesn't just mean affordable it signals you might be desperate, available, and willing to negotiate downward.
 - ☐ **Know Your Pricing Message:** Use this understanding to strategically raise your rates because higher prices filter out problem clients and attract those who respect your value.
 - ☐ **Know Your Pricing Message:** Track your Client Avatar and pricing together so that rate increases are aligned with your ideal client profile and attract the right segment.
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